

Recover your online identity

Your online identity is your second life of sorts. When you lose parts of it, nothing is more frustrating. Find out how to reclaim what's rightfully yours!

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Recovering domain names

There could be a multitude of reasons for you to lose control of your domain. It might have expired because you failed to renew it or the person who's technically the owner, is untraceable or was an employee and has left the company. In this case you might not have any means to get the renewal notifications. What do you do?

Most often you can recover a domain name even after it has expired or you don't have direct access to it. In case of



Get domain information from www.who.is

expired domains, there's a grace period of a week to 45 days for you to buy it back from the registrar, during which time it won't be made available to other people. If the domain hasn't expired and you don't have direct access to credentials you can contact the domain registrar directly. You can get this information by checking the Whois information (www.whois.com). After explaining your situation, the registrar will require you to go through certain formalities like fax identification and proof that the domain is yours. After a review period you're normally given the domain if you're found to be the rightful owner.

Recovering your Facebook account through friends

It's very easy for someone to gain access to your Facebook account if the perpetrator gets access to your password. This is possible even if your primary email account is compromised. Being locked out of both,

your email and Facebook account can be frustrating but Facebook lets you gain access by another alternative: "Recovering your account through friends" It lets you prove your identity when you're completely locked out. For a user's privacy and security and to avoid the



Get the security codes from your friends

misuse of this feature, Facebook will only reset your account login information after making sure of your identity. It lets you choose a few trusted friends to prove that the particular account is yours. Each of your chosen friends will be sent a security code and you can call these friends, collect your codes and follow instructions on the Facebook page to reset your password.

In case someone gets your Facebook password, logs in and changes the password, there are other steps you can take to minimise the damage to your social profile. Logging in with your old password will alert Facebook that something went wrong and you'll get a notification that it's your old password and it was changed on some date. Here you get an option to either reset your password or temporarily lock your account. You can instantly lock your account and nobody can misuse your information. Once the account is locked, you can reset your password through your email account.

Get back suspended Google+ accounts

Google has been constantly trying to eliminate fake profiles in the past few

months. Unfortunately though, many genuine profiles might be considered fake and you might have your profile suspended if Google finds some suspicious activity on it. In case your account is suspended, you'll still be able to view your stream and notifications but not edit or add anything to your profile. To recover your Google+ profile fill up the appeal form which will be provided to you during the sign-up process. You'll need to wait for about 24 hours before Google verifies the legitimacy of your claim. You'll then need to provide your contact number and verify your identity by voice or SMS.

Password reset through SMS in Twitter

You can use conventional methods to reset your password in Twitter through the "Forgot password?" link and enter your email address or Twitter username. Twitter additionally needs you to verify your identity by entering your phone number. You can also send yourself a password reset via SMS. If your mobile number is connected to your account and you've enabled password resets



Resetting Twitter password through your phone

via SMS through the Mobile Settings page previously, you may receive a password reset via SMS/text message. Simply go to https://twitter.com/account/resend_password on a computer and enter your email/username and mobile number. Then select the Phone Reset option and Twitter will text you a 6-digit code that's valid for 15 minutes. You can then change your password by entering this code on the web. 